

Discussion Exercise: Shisa Kanko in the Workshop

1. **The Science of Safety:** According to the video, why is the combination of pointing and verbalizing more effective than just looking at something? [\[00:58\]](#)
2. **Welding Hazards:** In your welding shop, what are the top three "critical points" (e.g., gas pressure, electrode settings, ventilation) where a mistake could be dangerous? Could this system work there?
3. **Cultural Barriers:** The video mentions that some people in Japan don't like the system because they feel "silly" or it feels like "extra work." [\[02:06\]](#) How would your welders react to being asked to point and call?
4. **Managing Resistance:** As a manager, if you decided to implement this, how would you explain the "85% error reduction" [\[01:14\]](#) to your team to convince them it isn't just a waste of time?
5. **Uniforms and Mindset:** The video shows railway employees in white gloves and uniforms. [\[00:00\]](#) Do you think wearing specific safety gear (like welding helmets and jackets) helps workers take safety protocols more seriously?
6. **Practical Application:** Could "Pointing and Calling" be used during the final inspection of a large welding project? What specific things would the inspector point at and say?

Six Dilemmas for Discussion

1. **The Experienced Veteran:** Your most skilled welder, who has 30 years of experience and a perfect safety record, refuses to "point and call" because he says it is "for beginners." Do you force him to comply to maintain shop-wide discipline, or do you respect his experience?
2. **The Deadline Pressure:** You have a massive order due tomorrow. Your team tells you they can finish on time, but only if they skip the "Pointing and Calling" checks to save a few seconds on every weld. Do you risk the deadline or the safety protocol?
3. **The "Robot" Effect:** You notice that after a month, your workers are pointing and calling "automatically" without actually looking at the gauges—it has become a mindless habit. How do you fix this so the "active awareness" mentioned in the video [\[00:58\]](#) returns?
4. **The Client Visit:** A high-profile international client is visiting your shop. They see your workers pointing at gas tanks and shouting "OK!" and they look confused/concerned about your staff's behavior. How do you defend the system without sounding like you've lost control?
5. **Budget Allocation:** You have enough budget to either: (A) Purchase the safety simulators mentioned in the video [\[01:26\]](#) to train your staff, or (B) Buy new, high-end ergonomic welding chairs for everyone. Which investment has a better long-term impact on your shop?
6. **The "Call" Error:** A worker points at a dial, calls "Voltage 20 volts!" but the dial actually says 40 volts. A mistake happens. Is the worker *more* responsible for the accident because they "confirmed" the wrong information out loud, or is it just a standard human error?

Video Link: [What's the Point of Pointing in Japan, Anyway?](#)